

Your Leadership Scenario

Template

Before you begin completing this Leadership Scenario template, ensure that you have reviewed the Leadership Scenario Overview in the Leadership Scenario section of the course content. This overview provides detailed instructions for completing each of the sections below.

Note that you will return to this document as you complete each domain course. You will be required to submit the completed Leadership Scenario document with the Final Project.

Organization Basics *To be completed prior to starting the first domain course

Nickname Shrey	Description A Regulated Pharmacy Technician (RPhT) acting as the Technical Lead within a high-volume Shoppers Drug Mart dispensary. This role involves managing a team of assistants and overseeing complex medication safety protocols in a fast-paced retail environment.
Describe a time when you were in a leadership position. I am currently serving as a Regulated Pharmacy Technician (RPhT) and Technical Lead at Shoppers Drug Mart, a role I have held for two years. This position is ongoing and involves high-stakes responsibility in a fast-paced retail healthcare environment. I was motivated to advance to this leadership role because I saw a critical need to bridge the gap between strict regulatory safety standards and the intense operational demands of a high-volume dispensary. My goal was to ensure that our team could maintain 100% technical accuracy and safety without sacrificing the efficiency required to serve our community effectively. As the lead, I am responsible for guiding the workflow of our assistants and ensuring that every medication dispensed meets the highest clinical standards, even during peak hours when the pressure to perform is at its highest.	
Describe the organizational culture. The culture is best described as "Performance-First." While the company's CORE values are Care, Ownership, Respect, and Excellence, the daily reality is heavily weighted toward "Ownership" (individual accountability) and "Excellence" (speed and accuracy). It is a culture that rewards clearing the prescription queue and meeting service quotas, such as MedsChecks and vaccinations. This often leads to a "Task-Oriented" environment where the pressure to perform can create tension between colleagues, sometimes overshadowing the values of "Care" and "Respect" for one another.	
What or whom were you accountable for? I am accountable for the final technical verification of all prescriptions, ensuring the right medication reaches the right patient in the right dose. I am also responsible for the management of the drugs inventory, which requires meticulous record-keeping. Beyond technical tasks, I am accountable for the workflow and performance of a team of 3 to 4 Pharmacy Assistants, ensuring they stay on task and follow safety protocols during high-volume periods	

Players

Key Internal Players						
	<i>Your Supervisor</i>	<i>Peer</i>		<i>Your Team</i>		
Nickname	The Designated Manager/Associate	Staff Pharmacist				Pharmacy Assistants
Key Responsibilities	Overall business profitability, meeting corporate quotas, and hiring.	Clinical verification, patient counseling, and minor ailment prescribing.				Prescription data entry, counting medication, and managing customer pickups.
Relationship Type	Formal and Metric-Based. They rely on me to keep the dispensary safe and efficient.	Professional and Collaborative. We work side-by-side but often focus on different tasks.				Direct Leadership. I manage their daily workflow and check their technical accuracy.
Personal Goals	To maintain a top-performing store within the Loblaw network.	To provide high-quality clinical care while getting through the shift on time.				To have a predictable, fair workday and avoid being overwhelmed by the pace.
Quirks and Conflicts	Prioritizes volume, which sometimes clashes with my focus on safety pauses.	Can be conflict-averse with customers, which sometimes puts pressure on the workflow.				They perceive my technical corrections as "scolding" due to my quiet, intense nature
Key External Players						
Nickname	Head Office	The Patients				
Contribution/ Purpose	Sets the standard operating procedures and performance metrics (SOPs)	The primary recipients of care who drive the daily demand.				

Relationship Type	Indirect. Their policies dictate our daily goals and resource allocation	Service Oriented. Interactions are often brief due to high-volume targets				
Quirks	Often introduces new clinical services without increasing labor hours	Expect immediate "retail speed" for complex medical prescriptions.				

Domain Activities

Each domain course (with the exception of Course 1 –Introduction to LEADS) has a Leadership Scenario Activity in the Learning Content that will require you to add or imagine additional information or circumstances to the scenario. As you are completing the Learning Content in each domain course, you will be prompted to complete the activities below.

Lead Self	For this section, you will need to identify the following: 1. The values of your organization. 2. The areas in which you believe you can grow in the organization. (For example, you may want to contribute to a different project or take on a new role that will challenge you.) Part One: 1. Organization Values: Care, Ownership, Respect, and Excellence (CORE) . 2. Areas for Growth: Moving from a "Technical Lead" into a broader "Pharmacy Operations Manager" role to influence system-wide safety . 3. Reflection: While Excellence (speed/accuracy) is highly visible, Care is often neglected during busy shifts. Evidence of this is seen in high stress and burnout levels among assistants. I would re-describe "Care" as: "We prioritize the well-being of our team as the foundation for providing safe care to our patients." Part Two I aspire to a leadership path that balances clinical safety with team health. This aligns with my goal of becoming a more empathetic leader who protects both the staff and the license of the pharmacy.
Engage Others	Workplace culture is a significant factor that influences engagement in one’s organization. While you will explore workplace culture in detail in Contribute to the Creation of Healthy Organizations, the concept is also the focus of this domain’s scenario activity. For this section, brainstorm concepts that describe the existing culture of your organization. 1. Metric-Driven: Success is measured by script volume and wait times, often creating a "rush" mentality. 2. Transactional Communication: During peak hours, interactions become brief and task-focused rather than supportive. 3. High Accountability: There is zero tolerance for technical error, which creates high individual pressure on all staff.
Achieve Results	For this section, you will need to identify the VUCA (volatile, uncertain, complex, ambiguous) areas within and outside of your organization. Identify two to three instances for each area. To expand on your reflection, indicate the pieces of vision, understanding, clarity in complexity, and agility that support you to lead in a VUCA environment. VUCA areas within and outside the organization:

	Volatility: Sudden unavailability of critical medications (e.g., children’s antibiotics or GLP-1 agonists) that require immediate workflow pivots, Sudden absences in a lean team that immediately compromises wait-time targets. Uncertainty: Periodic provincial shifts in pharmacy professional service fees (e.g., MedsCheck or vaccination funding) that impact business planning. Unpredictable spikes in walk-in clinic patients or prescription transfers that occur without warning. Complexity: Managing the clinical, legal, and documentation requirements of minor ailment prescribing alongside traditional dispensing, Navigating different insurance plans, each with unique rejection codes and requirements. Ambiguity: Interpreting evolving OCP guidelines regarding remote supervision or new technician roles., Balancing the corporate "retail speed" brand with the clinical reality that some medical checks cannot be rushed. To lead effectively at Shoppers Drug Mart, I use the "VUCA Prime" model to counter these challenges: • Vision: Our organizational vision, "To be the leader in helping Canadians discover a healthier outlook on life," acts as my "North Star". When volatility hits, I remind the team that our goal isn't just to "fill scripts," but to ensure patient health, which helps us prioritize tasks correctly. • Understanding: I build understanding by being a "curious" leader. When uncertainty arises, I communicate openly with my Associate and my team to understand the root cause of the stress before making decisions. • Clarity: To manage complexity, I simplify processes through my "Sustainable Safety Initiative". By having a clear 10-minute huddle, we create a "shared map" for the day, which reduces the mental fog of a complex dispensary environment. • Agility: I foster agility by empowering my assistants. Instead of being a rigid, top-down leader, I encourage a flexible workflow where we can shift roles quickly (e.g., moving someone from phones to the counter) based on the immediate pressure of the day. Reflection: Leading in a VUCA Environment To manage these areas effectively and achieve results, I apply the following leadership principles: • Vision: Our vision of "helping Canadians discover a healthier outlook" serves as a constant anchor. When the environment becomes volatile, I remind the team that our priority is the patient’s health outcome, not just the volume of the queue. • Understanding: I counter uncertainty by gathering information. By being a "curious" leader, I take the time to listen to my assistants’ concerns during huddles to understand where the system is breaking before I try to fix it. • Clarity in Complexity: To handle complexity, I provide a clear "shared map". My Sustainable Safety Initiative (the wellness huddle) cuts through the noise of a busy dispensary by setting clear, simple expectations for the shift ahead. • Agility: I lead with agility by being a "Systems-First" leader. Instead of sticking to a rigid plan, I empower my team to move fluidly between roles as the environment shifts, ensuring we are always positioned to catch errors and support one another.
Develop Coalitions	The concept of coalition-building sounds intimidating, especially if you feel you have not been a part of a formal coalition. However, collaborative effort is integral to health and community systems and it is likely you can draw on your experience in a partnership of some kind. For this section, answer the following questions: 1. What are examples of high-quality coalitions that you have experienced? It can be ones you were a part of, or perhaps ones that you were able to observe. - One high-quality coalition I observed and participated in was the collaboration between the Dispensary Team and the Front Store Manager (FSM) during the rollout of a massive seasonal vaccination clinic. This partnership allowed the pharmacy

	to focus on clinical safety while the front store handled line-ups and administrative check-ins. 2. In your opinion, what are a few ‘best’ practices when it comes to building coalitions? Shared Vision: Ensuring all parties understand how the collaboration benefits the entire store, not just one department. Stakeholder Mapping: Identifying who has the power and interest to make the coalition successful. , Open Communication: Establishing regular check-ins to address friction before it escalates. 3. What are some advantages to the coalitions you outlined in question one? The primary advantage was resource sharing. By working together, we reduced the "silo" effect, lowered the stress levels of the pharmacy staff, and improved the overall customer experience by reducing wait times and confusion. 4. What are some of the challenges the coalitions from question one faced? The biggest challenge was conflicting priorities. The Front Store is driven by merchandising and sales targets, while the Pharmacy is driven by safety and clinical standards. This led to friction regarding staffing levels and noise from overhead paging. 5. Is working together always better? Explain your answer. Yes, but only if there is alignment. In a retail healthcare environment, every department affects the patient's journey. If we do not work together, the "people" element—both staff and patients—suffers because the system becomes fragmented and inefficient.
System Transformation	
	For this domain, you will choose a major change initiative that your organization has undertaken or should undertake. A major change initiative should impact multiple areas of the organization and require the buy-in of many people, including leadership (you, your peers, and your supervisor) and your teammates. You only need to describe the change in two to three sentences. Remember that you are applying the concepts from this domain. This means that you can base your change on a real event and then adjust it to effectively demonstrate your understanding. You may also imagine and describe a change that you believe would benefit the organization but that has not yet occurred. As you think through the change and complete the domain assignment, you may go back and add details to the scenario that will help you better apply your understanding of the concepts. I am implementing a mandatory daily "Workflow & Wellness Huddle" at the start of overlap shifts. This initiative shifts our leadership focus from a "task-first" mentality to a "capacity-first" model. By taking 10 minutes to assess team stress levels and technical capacity before the rush begins, we operationalize Care as a safety standard. This change requires buy-in from the Pharmacy Associate (for paid time) and the Assistants (for participation) to ensure high performance is sustainable and safe.

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